COUNTY GOVERNMENT OF BUSIA • HANDBOOK • 2026

END EARLY PREGNANCIES

A Campaign For All



EMPOWERING GIRLS • PROTECTING FUTURES • BUILDING HOPE

In Partnership with

Kenya Red Cross

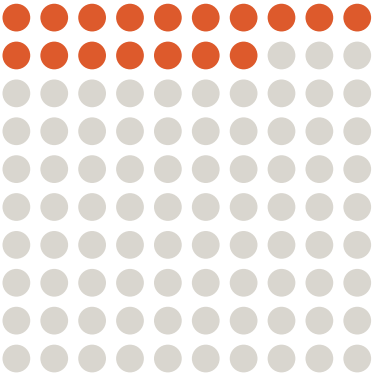
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STOP EARLY PREGNANCIES | BUSIA COUNTY

YOUR FUTURE.
YOUR CHOICE.

A handbook for teenagers



17

in every 100

teenage girls in Busia get pregnant too early.

It does not have to be you.

Together we can change this number.

WHAT IS TEENAGE PREGNANCY?

Pregnancy during adolescence can affect a young person's education, health, emotional well-being, relationships and future economic opportunities.

Teenage pregnancy
Pregnancy occurring during adolescence, generally among girls aged 10–19 years.

It can happen early
A girl can become pregnant once ovulation begins, even if she has only recently started menstruating – and before she feels physically, emotionally or socially ready to be a mother.

Why it happens: causes and what puts girls at risk

- Limited knowledge about sexual health and reproduction
- Poor decision-making skills and low self-esteem
- Peer pressure and influence from social media
- Social gatherings (disco matanga, keshas, back-to-school parties), especially without adult supervision
- Persuasion by older boys and men
- Transactional sex (sex for money or gifts)
- Child marriage
- Alcohol and drug use

Dangers of early pregnancy to a girl

- Anaemia (lack of enough blood in the body)
- High blood pressure in pregnancy, which can be life-threatening
- Difficult labour because the body is still growing: it can cause lifelong injury or even death
- Unsafe abortion attempts that can end in death
- Low birth weight and premature babies
- Mental and emotional distress
- Education stopped for a time or for good, and fewer chances for further education and work
- Stigma, discrimination and rejection

Sex at a young age is risky, with or without pregnancy

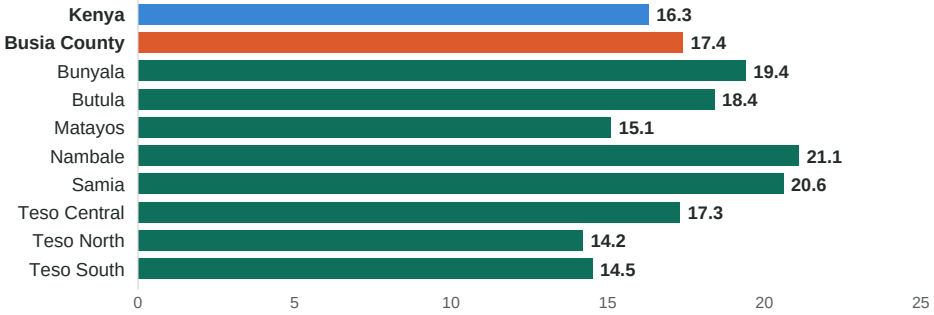
- Sex at a young age is dangerous even when no pregnancy happens. It exposes girls to HIV and other infections, to pressure, sexual violence and exploitation, and to fear, shame and emotional hurt.
- Sex with a child under 18 is a crime in Kenya (defilement). It is never the girl's fault.

KNOW THE FACTS

Good news: Busia County's number is going down.

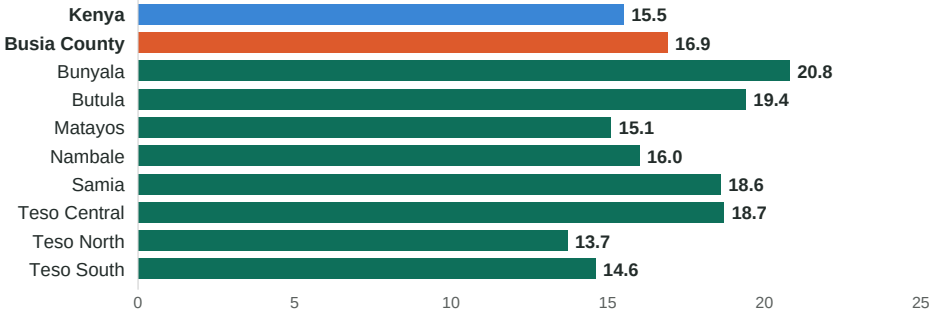
2025

Teenage pregnancy, out of every 100 girls



2026

Teenage pregnancy, out of every 100 girls



Busia County fell from 17.4 in 2025 to 16.9 in 2026. Every sub-county has a role to play in bringing the number down further.

In short: why we are doing this

Early pregnancy takes away a girl's health, her schooling and her dreams. This campaign gives you the facts so you can protect your future.

Why it happens

- Pressure from friends, boys and men
- Little true information
- Social gatherings and alcohol
- Gifts and money in exchange for sex

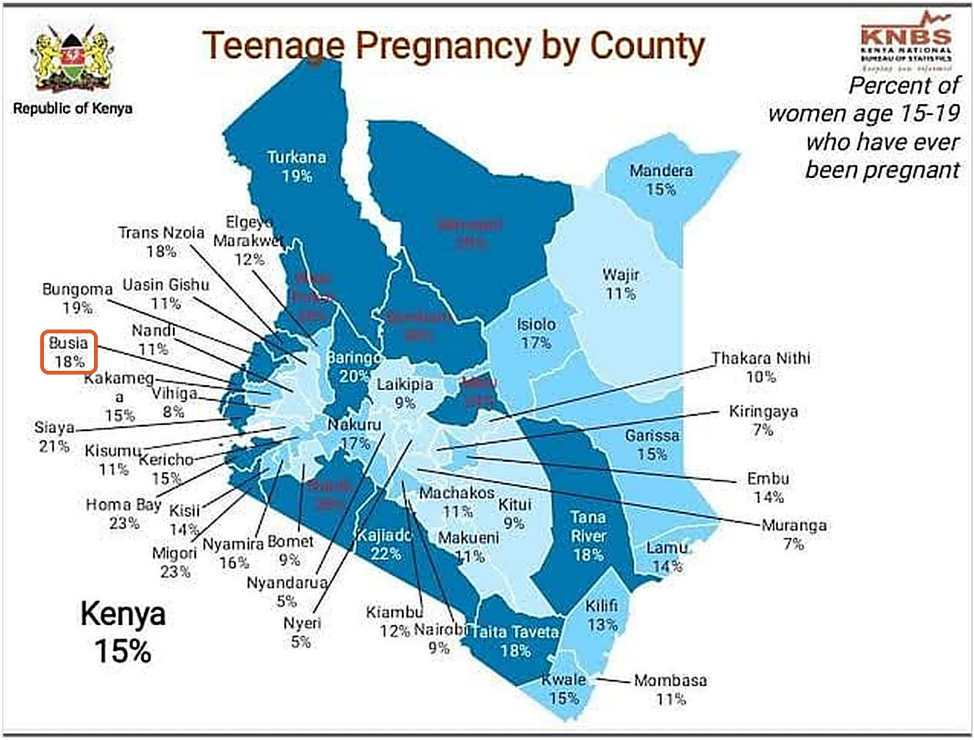
The dangers

- Health risks for you and your baby
- Leaving school, losing your dreams
- HIV and other infections
- Stigma and rejection

What you can do

- Say NO and stay in school
- Choose safe places and friends
- Tell a trusted adult
- See a health worker early

TEENAGE PREGNANCY BY COUNTY



Percent of women aged 15–19 who have ever been pregnant. Source: Kenya National Bureau of Statistics (KNBS).

Pregnancy can stop your dreams
But it does not have to be the end. With support, a girl can go back to school.

Pressure is not love
No one has the right to pressure or force you. Gifts or money do not mean you owe anyone anything.

Early care protects you
Think you may be pregnant? See a health worker quickly. It is private and you will be helped.

HOW TO PROTECT YOURSELF

Make healthy choices

- Practise abstinence from sex
- Concentrate on your education
- Develop personal career goals
- Set personal boundaries
- Avoid alcohol, drug and substance abuse
- Use social media wisely
- Spend time with productive friends
- Take part in sports and youth activities

Resist peer pressure and persuasion by boys and men

- Say “No” clearly and firmly. You do not owe anyone an explanation
- Walk away, leave early or go with a trusted friend if you feel pressured
- Choose friends who respect your choices
- Gifts, money, lifts or promises are not love. You owe nothing in return
- Be careful with older boys and men who give you special attention or gifts
- Never accept sex in exchange for money or gifts
- Avoid being alone with someone who pressures you
- Tell a trusted adult if someone keeps pushing you

Be careful when someone:

- Entices you to have sex
- Threatens you
- Controls your friends or your phone
- Demands sexual photographs
- Gives gifts in exchange for sex
- Uses alcohol or drugs to influence you

If it is a must that you have sex, use contraceptives.

They are readily available at nearby hospitals and clinics. Ask a health worker which method is right for you. Condoms also protect against HIV and other infections.

MYTHS, FACTS AND KEY MESSAGES

MYTH **A girl cannot become pregnant the first time she has sex.**
FACT Pregnancy can occur even on the first time.

MYTH **A girl cannot become pregnant if she has not started regular periods.**
FACT Ovulation can occur before a first or regular period.

MYTH **You cannot get pregnant during your period.**
FACT Pregnancy is still possible because cycles vary and sperm can survive for several days.

MYTH **Sex is safe as long as a girl does not get pregnant.**
FACT Sex at a young age is risky even without pregnancy: it can bring HIV and other infections, pressure, violence, fear and emotional hurt.

MYTH **Talking to adolescents about sex encourages sex.**
FACT Accurate, age-appropriate information helps young people make informed decisions.

MYTH **Only girls are responsible for teenage pregnancy prevention.**
FACT Pregnancy prevention is a shared responsibility between boys and girls.

MYTH **A pregnant adolescent should be rejected.**
FACT She needs health care, protection, support and opportunities to continue her life.

MYTH **Sexual violence is the victim's fault.**
FACT Sexual violence is the responsibility of the perpetrator.

Key messages for adolescent girls

- Protect your future: delay sexual activity until you are ready and able to make responsible decisions.
- Your body belongs to you. You have the right to set boundaries and say NO.
- No one should force you into sexual activity. This is sexual harassment. Report anyone who sexually harasses you.
- Talk to a trusted adult or qualified health worker when you have questions about sexual and reproductive health.
- Avoid alcohol and drugs that can impair your judgement and increase vulnerability.
- A healthy relationship is based on respect, consent, trust and responsibility.
- Pregnant adolescents need support, not stigma.

WHAT YOU CAN DO & GET HELP

1. **Talk**
   Tell one adult you trust: a parent, teacher, counsellor or health worker.
2. **Say NO to pressure**
   You decide when you are ready. Nobody can force you.
3. **Get true information**
   Ask at a youth-friendly clinic. Do not depend on rumours.
4. **Go early**
   Think you may be pregnant? Go to the clinic quickly. You will not be laughed at.
5. **Stay in school**
   Pregnancy is not the end of learning. Ask your school how to continue.

If someone forces or pressures you:

1. **Get to a safe place.**
2. **Tell a trusted adult.**
3. **Report it. It is NOT your fault.**

116 — **Childline Kenya**
Free call. For children.

1195 — **GBV helpline**
Free call. Help and rescue.

County Government of Busia

Tel: +254 700 106 517 Mon–Fri, 8.00 am – 5.00 pm

Email: info@busiacounty.go.ke

Adults I can talk to

Name _____ Phone _____

Name _____ Phone _____

Name _____ Phone _____

My nearest hospital or clinic _____

You can seek help at a nearby hospital or clinic.

If you think you may be pregnant, or you need advice, care or protection, go to your nearest hospital or youth-friendly clinic. Health workers will help you, and you will not be laughed at.

You deserve information, safety, respect, healthcare and a chance to learn and build your future.